Grotto of the Golden Swan

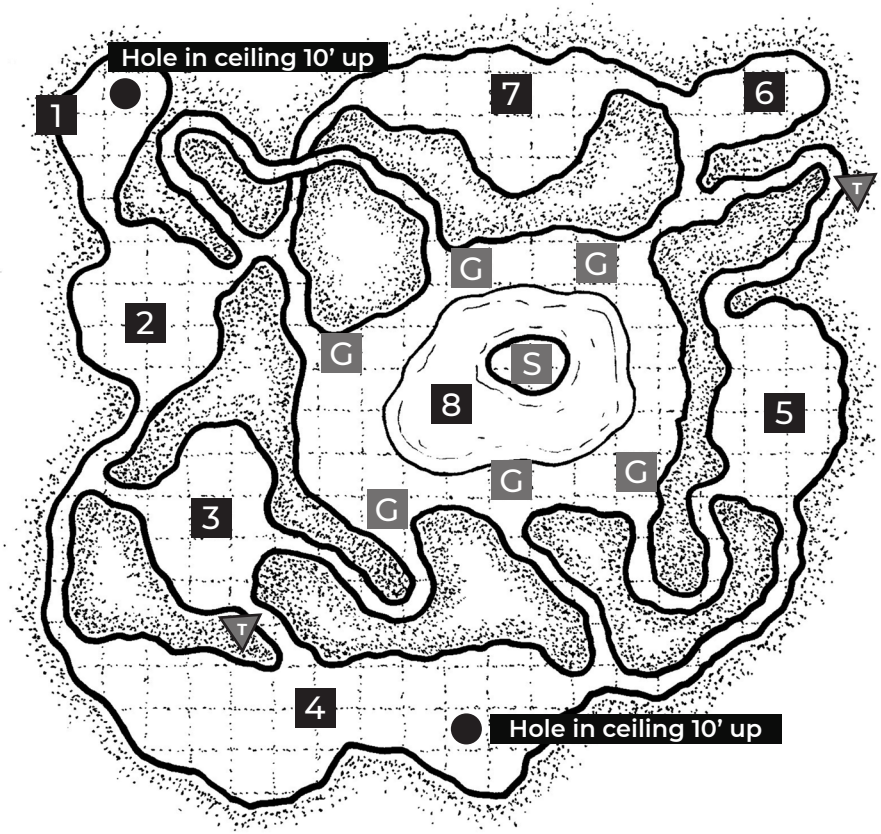
A golden swan egg is worth more than six merchants and their donkeys!

The **golden swan** lays her precious eggs inside a sunlit grotto of caves in the forest. But she is not alone! Fey guardians sent by the Swan Prince protect her and her nest. Can the characters seize one of her eggs and escape with a small fortune?

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

d4	Details
1	A **spectral guardian** silently patrols the tunnels (see Area 8)
2	1d4 mangy **bandits** tail the PCs, looking for opportunities
3	An **acolyte** brings holy offerings
4	1d4 curious **fairies** flit around

Golden Swan. *A regal swan with pure gold feathers that glow with inner light.* **AC** 12, **HP** 19, **ATK** 2 beak +4 (1d6) or 1 song, **MV** near (fly), **S** +1, **D** +2, **C** +1, **I** -2, **W** +1, **Ch** +2, **AL** N, **LV** 4. **Song.** All in near DC 12 CHA or blinded by tears 1d4 rds.



T Rock Fall: DC 12 DEX or 1d4 damage, random encounter check

Shadowdark RPG

3rd-Level

K. Dionne, 2026

1. Grotto Entrance. Narrow cave, cool and damp, smells of fresh rain. A high-relief **carving** of a stately angel with a mighty sword and shield wraps its wings out along the walls. It subtly moves as if breathing. A person who enters the cave in possession of a **golden egg** (see Area 8) causes the carving to erupt from the wall as a hostile **domini angel**. A **hole** in the ceiling 10' up goes to the surface.

2. Swan Songs. Two exquisite **stained glass swans** with curving necks hang like chandeliers. One is smoky black, the other prismatic white. The **black swan** sings a fluting dirge when touched and weeps 1d4 golden tears (treat as gp). The **white swan** sings a joyful hymn when touched, healing listeners 1 HP. Activating either more than 3 times/day causes it to snap at the offender (DC 12 DEX or 1d4 damage) and refuse to sing.

- **Noise.** Each time a swan sings, cumulative 1:6 chance 4 **spectral guardians** (Area 8) come investigate.

3. Father's Nest. A massive white **swan** sleeps soundly in a floor nest, head tucked under his wing. DC 12 DEX each round to move without waking him (treat as a **mastiff**). Golden egg **shells** litter the nest (worth 60 gp total).

- **Noise.** The **golden swan** comes with 4 **spectral guardians** (Area 8) to investigate unusual noises.

4. Cave of Portents. Jola Madroth, a shy and superstitious young **peasant**, lies on the floor by a lantern. She stares at the thick layer of purple quartz on the ceiling, hoping to glimpse a portent about her unrequited love. A **hole** in the ceiling 10' up goes to the surface.

5. Offering Cave. Hundreds of burning **candles** and **incense sticks** fill the cave with a warm glow and strong perfume. Scattered on the floor are dozens of **gold pieces** (80 total). Leaving 1 gp grants a luck token (once a day). Taking any removes the offender's luck tokens.

6. False Eggs. A cozy little cave with a warm swan **nest**. Scattered within are 10 golden swan feathers (each worth 2 gp) and two coconut-sized **golden eggs**. The eggs are trapped fakes; DC 12 DEX when handling one or it cracks, spilling acid (1d6 damage). If put in a backpack, it breaks, destroying 1d4 pieces of gear.

7. Tapestry Cave. Six woven tapestries depict flowery forest scenes of birds, swans, and unicorns. Behind one hides a niche housing an *Alabaster Destrier*.

8. Golden Grotto. Unmoving, ghostly knights (8 **spectral guardians**) stand at attention facing away from a knee-high **pond** dappled with thin beams of sunlight. The regal **golden swan** sits in a nest on an island at the center of the pond. She incubates three coconut-sized **golden eggs**, each worth 500 gp.

- **Golden Swan.** She only attacks in defense of herself or the eggs. She goes to Area 3 to investigate unusual noise near her mate's sleeping nest.
- **Spectral Guardians.** They only leave their posts to investigate loud noises for 1d4 rounds (the nearest 4 go).

Spectral Guardian. *Shimmering, ghostly knights with indistinct faces.* **AC** 15 (chainmail + shield), **HP** 5, **ATK** 1 longsword +2 (1d8), **MV** near, **S** +1, **D** +0, **C** +1, **I** +0, **W** +1, **Ch** +0, **AL** L, **LV** 1. **Ghostly.** Ignore any non-magical damage dealt to the knight of 3 points total or less.